



## STATUS REPORT

# Lesotho: status report

Edition of 2026-08-27-2 · 68 systems and instruments tracked

Compiled 2026-08-27 by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository, from [outputs/reports/LS0/Ledger.csv](#) (68 systems and instruments, 2 of them **Not held**). Each section opens with its ledger; specific events are covered in the monthly updates. Figures are dated because most are time-varying.

SUMMARY OF POSITION · GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS · GAPS TO FILL

**Status values.** *Implemented* — in operation or in force. *Piloting* — running with a limited user group or in a controlled environment. *In development* — build or drafting under way, not yet operating. *Planned* — announced or provided for, no build or draft on record. *Enacted* — an instrument passed into law; pair with a qualifying clause for its in-force date. *Under review* — a law or policy currently being reconsidered. *Discontinued* — closed or superseded. *Not held* — the base carries no reliable statement of status; these are the gaps to fill and are listed again at the end.

## Summary of position

Lesotho's current position rests on a payments and social-protection layer that has been running for several years, and a policy layer signed in the middle of 2026 whose texts are not on file. The [LeSwitch](#) national switch clears instant payments, ATM withdrawals and card transactions at point of sale inside the country across four commercial banks, and the mobile wallets that sit on it now carry a [licensed retail investment product](#). The social registry holds data on [more than 90% of households](#). Against that, the framework governing personal data is a statute from 2011 whose supervisory commission [has never been appointed](#).

The three foundational policies — broadband infrastructure sharing, data management and artificial intelligence — were [signed on 12 June 2026](#), and the wiki holds the reported signings rather than the instruments, so what each requires, of whom and by when cannot be stated from the base.

The largest commitment on the record is Project Kobong, [approved on 31 July 2026](#): at least 1,200MW of pumped-storage hydropower paired with an AI data centre at Mokhotlong, on an agreement binding as to process but conditional on feasibility, financing, permitting and definitive agreements, with construction targeted for 2029. The maloti figure is the government's throughout; [Convalt Energy's own release](#) of 8 June 2026 confirms the agreement and the capacities and states no value.

An interim national CSIRT [began operating on 29 July 2026](#) while the two bills that would give it a statutory footing await National Assembly approval, and the National Cybersecurity Strategy the launch was described as implementing is not held here.

## Governance

### Strategies, plans and policies

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                  | STATUS <a href="#">↗</a> <a href="#">source</a> | MILESTONE                                     |
|-------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| Broadband Infrastructure Sharing Policy               | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>                   | Signed by the MICSTI minister, 2026-06-12     |
| Data Management Policy                                | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>                   | Signed by the MICSTI minister, 2026-06-12     |
| National AI Policy                                    | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>                   | Signed by the MICSTI minister, 2026-06-12     |
| National AI Strategy                                  | IN DEVELOPMENT <a href="#">↗</a>                | Drafting workshop opened in Maseru 2026-08-17 |
| National Digital Policy 2024                          | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>                   | Issued in 2024                                |
| National Digital Transformation Strategy: Agenda 2030 | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>                   | Launched in 2024                              |

### Legislation and regulation

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT | STATUS <a href="#">↗</a> <a href="#">source</a> | MILESTONE                                       |
|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| Cybercrime Bill      | IN DEVELOPMENT <a href="#">↗</a>                | Awaiting National Assembly approval, 2026-07-29 |
| Cybersecurity Bill   | IN DEVELOPMENT <a href="#">↗</a>                | Awaiting National Assembly approval, 2026-07-29 |

### Data protection

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                              | STATUS <a href="#">↗</a> <a href="#">source</a> | MILESTONE                                                                |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Bilateral health agreement with the United States and its data-sharing instrument | IMPLEMENTED, TEXT WITHHELD <a href="#">↗</a>    | Signed in December 2025, stated at US\$364m                              |
| Data Protection Act 2011                                                          | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>                   | In force since 2011                                                      |
| Data Protection Commission                                                        | PLANNED <a href="#">↗</a>                       | Provided for by the 2011 Act; no commissioner appointed as at 2026-03-23 |

### Regional collaboration

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                              | STATUS <a href="#">↗</a> <a href="#">source</a> | MILESTONE                                                  |
|---------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| 50-in-5 DPI campaign membership                   | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>                   | Joined as the fourteenth member, May 2024                  |
| African Union Data Policy Framework domestication | IN DEVELOPMENT <a href="#">↗</a>                | Readiness workshop convened by AUDA-NEPAD, 28-31 July 2025 |

### Standards

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                   | STATUS <a href="#">↗</a> <a href="#">source</a> | MILESTONE                                                 |
|--------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| LCA Quality of Service Rules (Legal Notice 41 of 2023) | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>                   | Legal Notice No. 41 of 2023 gazetted, in force 2023-04-21 |

### Public debate and participation in policymaking

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                 | STATUS <a href="#">↗</a> <a href="#">source</a> | MILESTONE                                             |
|------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| Allegation of interference in regulator appointments | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>                   | Allegation made at a media briefing, August 2026      |
| Communications consumer perception survey            | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>                   | 2026 survey published by the communications authority |
| Public digital services experience survey            | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>                   | Opened 2026-08-09                                     |

Two instruments carry the framework: the National Digital Policy 2024 and the National Digital Transformation Strategy: Agenda 2030. Three more — broadband infrastructure sharing, data management and artificial intelligence — were signed in June 2026 and none of the texts is held; all three were already reported under development in the [2025/26 budget speech of 19 February 2025](#), more than a year before signature.

The [LCA Quality of Service Rules](#), gazetted 21 April 2023, set the one published, binding standard in this area, with minimum thresholds for voice, data, postal and courier licensees. The LCA's [Annual Report 2024/25](#) recorded 75% overall compliance across twelve general parameters for the year to 31 March 2025, missing on disconnection-complaint resolution time and mobile order-completion time; its [Q3 2025/26 drive-testing](#) in Maseru, November 2025, measured mean LTE download speeds of 2.88-2.95 Mbps against the Rules' 25 Mb/s target.

Personal data is governed by an Act in force since 2011. The Data Protection Commission it provides for was still unappointed as at March 2026, which is stated by [Cenfri](#) rather than by the government. No regulator is therefore in place to approve, audit or refuse a data flow.

Regional alignment is convened rather than completed. A four-day AUDA-NEPAD workshop on domesticating the African Union Data Policy Framework [ran in July 2025](#), and no readiness assessment, legislative review or resulting instrument from it is held. Lesotho joined the [50-in-5 campaign](#) as its fourteenth member in May 2024.

No government open-data portal is held. An [SBC4D/IREX capacity assessment](#) prepared for the Millennium Challenge Corporation and the Lesotho Millennium Development Agency, dated September 2021, found no active government open-data programme, a civil-society Lesotho Open Data Initiative launched in 2019, a ranking of 151st of 187 countries in Open Data Watch's 2020 Open Data Inventory, and no access-to-information legislation in force.

The one governance instrument that is known to exist and known to be withheld is the bilateral health agreement with the United States, [signed in December 2025 and stated at US\\$364m](#). A [FOIA complaint filed on 2 April 2026](#) records that the State Department briefly published a subset of the memoranda in March 2026 and then removed public access, and that the related data-sharing agreements have not been published; Lesotho is one of sixteen countries named.

## Finance

### Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                     | STATUS ↗ source | MILESTONE                                                                                      |
|----------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Domestic budget appropriation for digital transformation | IMPLEMENTED ↗   | M381.1 million allocated to the ICT sector, delivered in the 2025/26 budget speech, 2025-02-19 |

### MoUs and other agreements

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                               | STATUS ↗ source | MILESTONE                                                                                        |
|----------------------------------------------------|-----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Development-partner support for the data blueprint | IMPLEMENTED ↗   | Smart Africa, the African Union and the German Embassy named as supporters of the first workshop |

A domestic budget line for digital transformation is on record for the first time. The [2025/26 budget speech](#), delivered 19 February 2025, allocated M381.1 million to the ICT sector and named a Government Security Operations Centre, a Government of Lesotho Enterprise Architecture and Interoperability Framework, a completed feasibility study for the Lesotho Metropolitan Fibre Distribution Network, 17 already-operational base tower stations and a 96km Roma-Thaba-Tseka fibre stretch under way.

Development-partner support for the National Data Value Creation Blueprint — Smart Africa, the African Union and the German Embassy — was named as supporting its [first workshop](#), with no programme document, terms of reference or amount published.

## ICT Infrastructure

### Connectivity

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                     | STATUS ↗ source  | MILESTONE                                                              |
|----------------------------------------------------------|------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Econet Telecom Lesotho 5G network                        | IMPLEMENTED ↗    | 5G sites grown from 54 to 149 on 700MHz                                |
| Econet Wi-Fi Plus fixed-mobile convergence service       | IMPLEMENTED ↗    | Launched 2025-07-11                                                    |
| Lesotho Metropolitan Fibre Distribution Network (LEMOFI) | IN DEVELOPMENT ↗ | Feasibility study completed, per the 2025/26 budget speech, 2025-02-19 |
| Starlink operating licence                               | IMPLEMENTED ↗    | Ten-year satellite internet licence granted by the LCA, 2025-04-14     |
| Starlink satellite internet service                      | IMPLEMENTED ↗    | Launched through T-Connect as exclusive reseller, 2025-06-30           |
| Vodacom Lesotho mobile network                           | IMPLEMENTED ↗    | Thirtieth-anniversary account of the network, 2026-06-17               |

### Data Storage

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                         | STATUS ↗ source  | MILESTONE                                                                |
|----------------------------------------------|------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| National data-centre implementation roadmap  | IN DEVELOPMENT ↗ | Drafting workshop opened in Maseru 2026-08-17                            |
| Project Kobong hydropower and AI data centre | PLANNED ↗        | Approved and launched at a ceremony hosted by the US Embassy, 2026-07-31 |

### Technical Capacity

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                 | STATUS ↗ source  | MILESTONE                                                                             |
|--------------------------------------|------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Mohale's Hoek government data centre | IN DEVELOPMENT ↗ | Toured near-complete by the Communications Minister; power station awaited (~2018-07) |

### Cybersecurity

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                          | STATUS ↗ source                                                                                                                                          | MILESTONE                                                                                                                  |
|-----------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Government Chief Information Security Officer | IMPLEMENTED ↗                                                                                                                                            | First appointment across government reported 2026-07-29                                                                    |
| Interim national CSIRT (LesComCSIRT)          | IMPLEMENTED, INTERIM ↗                                                                                                                                   | Launched in Maseru 2026-07-29                                                                                              |
| National Cybersecurity Forum                  | IMPLEMENTED ↗                                                                                                                                            | Inaugural meeting 2026-07-29                                                                                               |
| National Security Operations Centre           | IN DEVELOPMENT ↗                                                                                                                                         | Reported being stood up, 2026-07-29                                                                                        |
| National Cybersecurity Strategy               | NOT HELD, SEARCHED 2026-08-10 — OXFORD/C3SA CYBERSECURITY CAPACITY MATURITY MODEL REVIEW RATED THE STRATEGY DIMENSION START-UP AND FOUND NO OFFICIAL NCS | Oxford/C3SA Cybersecurity Capacity Maturity Model review confirmed no official National Cybersecurity Strategy, 2023-03-31 |

The mobile market has two operators and a satellite entrant. Vodacom Lesotho reported [1.21m customers and 85% market share at its thirtieth anniversary in June 2026](#), on 422 base stations of which 101 are solar, with 4G reaching 96% of the population; a US\$40m upgrade was [announced in March 2026](#). Econet Telecom Lesotho's most recent

published network figure is [149 5G sites on 700MHz in June 2025](#), and nothing later is held. A separate fibre backbone, the Lesotho Metropolitan Fibre Distribution Network, had its feasibility study completed by the time of the [2025/26 budget speech of 19 February 2025](#), with no construction reported since.

Starlink holds a ten-year licence [granted on 14 April 2025](#) and has been retailing through T-Connect since June 2025. [The rights group Section 2 objected](#) that full foreign ownership departs from the local-participation terms attached to both mobile operators, and Vodacom's appeal for local shareholding has no recorded outcome.

The [Mohale's Hoek data centre was toured near-complete on 24 May 2018](#), a Tier III design built as 100km-separated backup to the Finance Ministry's Maseru data centre, left needing only its power station; no later source confirms completion or operational status. Project Kobong is the newer and far larger commitment: no rack, floor-area or power figure has been published for it either, and the project's own premise is that the electricity does not yet exist – about 72MW installed against about 209MW of domestic demand, with [438 of the 970 GWh consumed in 2024 imported](#).

The cybersecurity institutions are new and, in the case of the response team, explicitly interim. Alongside the CSIRT and the National Cybersecurity Forum, the ministry reports a first Chief Information Security Officer appointed across government and a Security Operations Centre being stood up, for which no host, operator or date is [published](#); the same centre was first budgeted, as a Government Security Operations Centre, in the [2025/26 budget speech](#) more than a year earlier. The minister dates the threat they answer to an attack on the government financial system in June 2023 that forced a shutdown, an attack on the Central Bank roughly six months later that stopped bank transfers, and attacks on the Judiciary's electronic systems. An [Oxford/C3SA capacity review](#) found the strategy the launch invoked did not officially exist as of 31 March 2023.

DPI

Data Exchange

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                         | STATUS ↗ source                  | MILESTONE                                                      |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Government of Lesotho Enterprise Architecture and Interoperability Framework | <a href="#">IN DEVELOPMENT ↗</a> | Under development, per the 2025/26 budget speech, 2025-02-19   |
| National Single Window                                                       | <a href="#">IMPLEMENTED ↗</a>    | Launched at Victory Hall, Maseru, 24 August 2026               |
| X-Road government interoperability platform                                  | <a href="#">IN DEVELOPMENT ↗</a> | Presented at the MICSTI-NUL review of DPI progress, 2026-02-20 |

Digital Identity and CRVS

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                            | STATUS ↗ source                  | MILESTONE                                                                                |
|-------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Digital birth registration under Ntlafatsa Bana | <a href="#">IMPLEMENTED ↗</a>    | Launched with the European Union and UNICEF, 2025-04-02                                  |
| Digital service-ID pilot                        | <a href="#">PILOTING ↗</a>       | Pilot programme set to begin 2026-04-02, about 10,000 participants, announced 2026-03-25 |
| MOSIP-based integrated national digital ID      | <a href="#">IN DEVELOPMENT ↗</a> | 2026 work plan signed by MICSTI and UNICEF, 2026-03-03                                   |
| National Identification System                  | <a href="#">IMPLEMENTED ↗</a>    | Documented in the World Bank GovTech case study, 2022                                    |
| Refugee identity-document freeze                | <a href="#">IMPLEMENTED ↗</a>    | Reported as leaving families stranded and bank accounts frozen, August 2026              |

Digital Payments and Fintech

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT | STATUS ↗ source               | MILESTONE                                 |
|----------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| EcoCash mobile money | <a href="#">IMPLEMENTED ↗</a> | Platform migration completed October 2024 |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                               | STATUS <a href="#">↗</a> <a href="#">source</a> | MILESTONE                                                                                |
|----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| LeSwitch national payment switch                   | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>                   | Card transactions at point of sale localised from 2025-05-11                             |
| M-Pesa Lesotho (VCL Financial Services)            | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>                   | Mobile money spun off into VCL Financial Services, 2026-03-13                            |
| Renminbi settlement access through CIPS            | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>                   | Standard Bank extended CIPS access beyond South Africa to five markets including Lesotho |
| Revenue Services Lesotho tax e-payment integration | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>                   | Launched with Standard Lesotho Bank, 2026-02-11                                          |
| Tsetela wallet investment service                  | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>                   | Launched in Maseru 2026-07-22                                                            |

## Registries

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT  | STATUS <a href="#">↗</a> <a href="#">source</a> | MILESTONE                                           |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| NISSA social registry | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>                   | Child-centred redesign piloted in Mafeteng District |

## Sectoral management information systems

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                  | STATUS <a href="#">↗</a> <a href="#">source</a> | MILESTONE                                                                 |
|-------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Decision Support System for planning and budgeting    | IN DEVELOPMENT <a href="#">↗</a>                | Presented at the MICSTI-NUL review of DPI progress, 2026-02-20            |
| Foundational Literacy and Numeracy Dashboard          | IN DEVELOPMENT <a href="#">↗</a>                | UNICEF and Global Partnership for Education support announced, 2026-07-23 |
| MISSA social-assistance management information system | IN DEVELOPMENT <a href="#">↗</a>                | Request for proposals closed 12 August 2024                               |
| National monitoring and evaluation reporting capacity | IN DEVELOPMENT <a href="#">↗</a>                | Consultancy advertised 2026-08-16                                         |

## Other GovTech and e-Gov

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                        | STATUS <a href="#">↗</a> <a href="#">source</a> | MILESTONE                                                                     |
|---------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| E-Parliament system                         | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>                   | Completion reported in the 2025/26 budget speech, 2025-02-19                  |
| eGovernment Infrastructure Project Phase II | IMPLEMENTED <a href="#">↗</a>                   | Digital Outreach Studio launched under the project, 2026-06-12                |
| National Data Value Creation Blueprint      | IN DEVELOPMENT <a href="#">↗</a>                | First national stakeholder consultative workshop, 14-15 July 2026             |
| Separate government ICT agency              | PLANNED <a href="#">↗</a>                       | Announced as a plan to move ICT services out of the civil service, 2026-07-29 |

Payments are the deepest part of the base. LeSwitch has localised instant transfers, ATM transactions and, since May 2025, card transactions at point of sale; e-commerce and retail were named as the next stage and nothing since is held. On top of it, Vodacom's mobile money was [reconstituted as VCL Financial Services in March 2026](#) and runs 14,000 agents, Econet's EcoCash has been on a [migrated platform since October 2024](#), and Tsetela opened investment from M50 for individual customers and M300 for group-savings customers over USSD. Two narrower rails were added in 2026: [tax e-payment](#) for company tax, PAYE, VAT and customs duties, and [renminbi settlement through CIPS](#).

Identity is the layer with the widest gap between activity and delivery. The National Identification System operates, but the most recent account of it held here is a [World Bank case study from 2022](#), so no current coverage or enrolment figure can be given. The replacement is a [MOSIP-based integrated national digital ID](#) under a 2026 work plan with UNICEF, covering passport and identity-card renewal, biometric registration and proof-of-life verification. A separate [digital service-ID pilot](#) of about 10,000 participants was announced on 25 March 2026 to begin 2 April

2026, tying registration to an existing national identity document, a registered SIM card and biometric registration; no vendor, legal basis or evaluation criteria has been stated. [Digital birth registration](#) runs under the Ntlafatsa Bana programme.

The interoperability and analytics layers are at presentation stage. X-Road and a Decision Support System were both [shown as work in progress in February 2026](#) with no go-live date, alongside a Government of Lesotho Enterprise Architecture and Interoperability Framework named as under development in the [2025/26 budget speech](#), aimed at government efficiency and avoiding fragmented ICT procurement. The [NISSA](#) registry is the exception — it is in operation and is being redesigned around children's data — while its management information system, MISSA, has not moved past a [request for proposals that closed in August 2024](#). The [eGovernment Infrastructure Project Phase II](#), an African Development Bank commitment of US\$13.95m made in 2019 and due to end in 2026, is the standing financing behind this layer; the same budget speech reported an E-Parliament system already completed, modernising legislative processes.

Sub-national government has one system on record: Maseru City Council's [Construction Permit Automation System](#), built by Computer Business Solutions (Lesotho) with Web Masters Kenya under World Bank funding, live at [mcc-cp.org.ls](#) from application through to digital permit issue.

## Digitalisation

### Digitalisation of sub-national government

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                      | STATUS ↗ source | MILESTONE                                                            |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Maseru City Council Construction Permit Automation System | IMPLEMENTED ↗   | Project page dated 2025-04-02; live at <a href="#">mcc-cp.org.ls</a> |

### Rural digital data capture

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                            | STATUS ↗ source | MILESTONE                                                        |
|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| T-Connect Impact school and clinic connectivity | IMPLEMENTED ↗   | Launched at Soofia International School, Butha-Buthe, 2026-01-17 |

Sub-national digitalisation is one connectivity programme rather than a service layer: [T-Connect Impact](#) connects schools and clinics, launched at Butha-Buthe in January 2026. No site count or funding line is held.

## Technology

### AI

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT | STATUS ↗ source | MILESTONE                                             |
|----------------------|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| National AI Academy  | PLANNED ↗       | Named in the UNDP-Econet memorandum signed 2026-07-28 |

### ICT Industry

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                            | STATUS ↗ source | MILESTONE                                                                   |
|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Private-sector cloud and cybersecurity capacity | IMPLEMENTED ↗   | Executive workshop hosted in Maseru by DNS Technologies and CBS, 2026-05-30 |

## Innovation ecosystem

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                    | STATUS ↗ source | MILESTONE                                              |
|-----------------------------------------|-----------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| UNDP-Econet memorandum of understanding | IMPLEMENTED ↗   | Signed at the Mpilo Boutique Hotel, Maseru, 2026-07-28 |

The artificial-intelligence position is an approved data-centre project, a signed policy whose text is not held, and one institutional commitment. A [National AI Academy](#) is proposed in the memorandum Econet Telecom Lesotho and UNDP signed on 28 July 2026, with no timetable, governance structure, curriculum or host institution named; the same memorandum renews a partnership first signed in 2020 and amended in 2022, and states no amount, term or deliverable.

Two external relationships shape the sector. The [Lesotho–India memorandum](#) of July 2025 named digital ID, a unified payment environment and once-only information exchange as the year's priorities, and no deliverable under it is on record. On the American side, the [US Embassy states](#) that it has facilitated US\$7.3bn of commercial partnerships in Lesotho over eighteen months, of which Kobong is the largest — the embassy's own figure, attributed as such.

Domestic technology capacity outside the two operators appears once, as an [executive workshop in Maseru](#) on ransomware, cloud security and data sovereignty.

## Capacity

### Training and skills

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                      | STATUS ↗ source | MILESTONE                                                               |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| AI Skills Development Programme                           | IMPLEMENTED ↗   | Launched with the US Embassy under the Sebatatso initiative, 2026-06-17 |
| Government digital-literacy training in all ten districts | IMPLEMENTED ↗   | Reported running across all ten districts, 2026-07-29                   |
| Vodacom and AWS digital-skills training                   | PLANNED ↗       | Pledged at the Vodacom group chief executive's visit, 2025-08-25        |

### Research institutions

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                            | STATUS ↗ source | MILESTONE                                                                                     |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Government and National University of Lesotho DPI collaboration | IMPLEMENTED ↗   | Joint review of DPI progress with the Mathematics and Computer Science department, 2026-02-20 |

Research capacity is a single standing collaboration: the ministry and the [National University of Lesotho jointly review digital public infrastructure progress](#). No research output, funded programme or centre mandate is held behind it.

## Inclusion

*The base holds no inclusion rows for Lesotho. A thin evidence base is a finding, not a gap in this document.*

The government's own measure of the access problem is coverage against use: [100% broadband coverage and about 50% regular internet use](#), which MICSTI attributed to affordability at the UN Global Dialogue on AI Governance in July 2026. Rural reach is being extended by satellite rather than by terrestrial network: [community hotspots](#) handed over through principal chiefs, and [school and clinic connectivity](#) from January 2026.

Training is thin and externally supplied. The [AI Skills Development Programme](#) with the US Embassy is the one programme on record delivering, digital-literacy training is reported across all ten districts with no participant numbers published, and a digital-skills pledge made with AWS in August 2025 has nothing recorded against it since.

As South African remittance and banking rules tightened, [migrant workers moved from banks to fintechs](#). No domestic budget appropriation for digital transformation is held, so what the state itself spends cannot be stated.

Data

Open data

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT      | STATUS ↗ source                                                                                                                                                 | MILESTONE                                                                                          |
|---------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| National open data portal | NOT HELD, SEARCHED 2026-08-10 – SBC4D/IREX CAPACITY ASSESSMENT FOUND NO ACTIVE GOVERNMENT OPEN-DATA PROGRAMME AND NO ACCESS-TO-INFORMATION LEGISLATION IN FORCE | SBC4D/IREX capacity assessment for MCC/LMDA found no government open-data activity, September 2021 |

No national open-data portal is held, and a capacity assessment searched in August 2026 found no active government open-data programme and no access-to-information legislation in force. That is a searched absence rather than a gap in this document.

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                      | STATUS ↗ source | MILESTONE                                                                               |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| US commercial diplomacy in the digital and energy sectors | IMPLEMENTED ↗   | US Embassy states US\$7.3bn of commercial partnerships facilitated over eighteen months |

India activities

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                   | STATUS ↗ source | MILESTONE                                                                |
|--------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Lesotho-India digital public infrastructure memorandum | IMPLEMENTED ↗   | Signed during the Indian minister of state's visit to Maseru, 2025-07-29 |

The external digital relationship on record is with India: a digital public infrastructure memorandum [signed during an Indian minister of state visit to Maseru in July 2025](#). Nothing on file records work done under it.

Gaps to fill

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT            | WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | LAST PROBED |
|---------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| National Cybersecurity Strategy | The text of the strategy the minister invoked at the LesComCSIRT launch, or an official statement of its adoption date, version and targets. The 2022 Cybersecurity Capacity Maturity Model review states Lesotho had no official national strategy. | 2026-08-10  |
| National open data portal       | A government open-data portal or published open-data policy for Lesotho, or an official statement that none exists.                                                                                                                                  | 2026-08-10  |

Two absences remain. The National Cybersecurity Strategy is invoked in official statements but has no published text; an [Oxford/C3SA capacity review](#) rated its strategy dimension Start-up and found no official strategy existed as of 31 March 2023, and nothing later on record supersedes that finding. No National open data portal is held either; an [SBC4D/IREX capacity assessment](#) found no active government open-data programme as of September 2021, and nothing later on record supersedes that finding.

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## ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

|                 |                                                                                                                                                                     |
|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| EDITION         | <b>2026-08-27-2</b>                                                                                                                                                 |
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Figures are dated because most are time-varying: a figure carries the date it was true, not the date you are reading it. Where the base holds no reliable statement, the document says **Not held** rather than leaving a silence — those are counted, and listed at the end.

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